

BRAND GUIDELINES

Visual identity and social media style guide

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SHARE TOOLS. BUILD TOGETHER.

ToolSynergy is a sharing platform for the DIY community. Members lend each other tools, swap know-how and take on projects side by side, so nobody has to buy a chainsaw for a single weekend.

One creative idea guides all communication: **people sharing creative projects with joy and pride.** People come first in every picture and every line of copy. Tools matter, but always in someone's hands.

Everything in this guide serves that idea. When a decision is unclear, pick the option that shows more of the people and less of the product.

THE CLAIM

„Gemeinsam mehr
schaffen.“

Achieve more together.

WHAT EVERY POST SHOULD SAY

- **COMMUNITY** we build things together
- **TIME-SAVING** the right tool is one member away
- **INSPIRING** finished projects spark new ones
- **TRUSTWORTHY** clear answers when things break
- **ACCESSIBLE** good tools, open to everyone

ONE MARK, ONE MESSAGE

The wrench opens the logo and leads the eye into the name, like a locomotive pulling its train. It stands for the one thing the platform does: putting tools into more hands.

The name is set in caps for legibility and split into two blues. The claim sits inside the mark and ends flush with the name, so the whole logo reads as one unit.



- The wrench leads the eye and frames the mark
- TOOL in Synergy Blue, the anchor
- SYNERGY in Sky Blue, the lift
- Claim in black caps, flush with the name

KEEP IT CLEAR



Primary. Full color on white or very light backgrounds.



Monochrome. One-color print, stamps and engraving.



Inverted. On Synergy Blue or dark photography.

CLEAR SPACE

Keep the height of the letter T free on all sides.

MINIMUM SIZE

180 px wide on screen, 45 mm in print.
Below that, use the wrench alone.

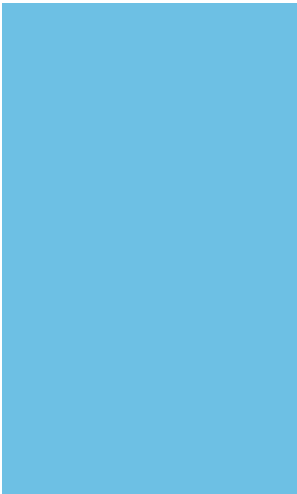
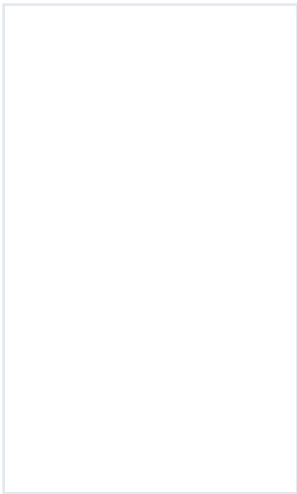
ON PHOTOS

Place the logo on a white brush stroke or a solid panel, never straight onto busy imagery.

NEVER

Recolor, stretch, rotate, rearrange the parts or add effects.

TRUST IN BLUE, WARMTH IN ORANGE

					
SYNERGY BLUE #0040A1 Trust and reliability. Headlines, panels, the anchor color.	SKY BLUE #6DC0E4 Fresh and open. Secondary accents and highlights on blue.	TOOL ORANGE #FFA500 Welcoming and energetic. Calls to action and small accents.	STEEL GRAY #808080 Neutral support. Captions, lines and quiet backgrounds.	BLACK #000000 Body copy and the claim in the logo.	WHITE #FFFFFF Air and clarity. The default canvas everywhere.

PROPORTIONS IN A TYPICAL LAYOUT

White 50	Blue 22	Sky 10	Gray 8	6	4
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Orange is an accent, not a base. Use it to point at things, never for long text or large areas.

HEADLINES

ALTERNATE GOTHIC

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
0123456789

Condensed, loud and always uppercase. Used big, with tight leading. It gives headlines the punch of a stencil on a workshop wall.

BODY

Open Sans

Tools bring people together. Regular 400

Tools bring people together. SemiBold 600

Tools bring people together. Bold 700

Friendly and easy to read at any size. Carries all running text, captions and interface copy.

WEEKEND PROJECT

BORROW A SANDER, MAKE A FRIEND

Post your project, pick up the tool around the corner and return it with a story.

Label · Open Sans SemiBold, caps
Headline · Alternate Gothic, 56–120 px
Body · Open Sans, 18–24 px

FEED POST

Headline 72 px, caption 34 px, both left aligned.

CAROUSEL

Step number 40 px, step title 56 px, one thought per card.

SHORT VIDEO

Subtitles 48 px minimum, always burned in.

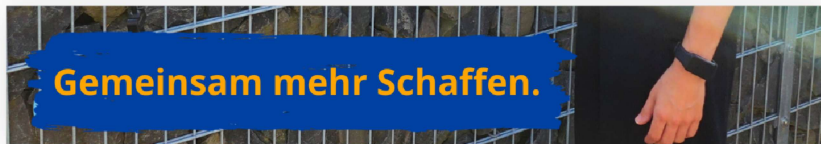
LINE LENGTH

Never more than 45 characters per line on a graphic.

HANDMADE, NOT POLISHED

THE BRUSH STROKE

A rough, imperfect stroke carries the claim or the logo over photography. It sits on the top or bottom edge of the image and comes in white or Synergy Blue only.



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- Do** Keep it white or Synergy Blue, and let the ends run past the text.
 - Do** One stroke per image, on the top or the bottom edge.
 - Don't** Place it over a face, tilt it, or fade it into the photo.

THE CHEVRONS

Two rounded chevrons signal that there is more to see: the next slide of a carousel, the next step of a build. Orange leads, blue follows. Bottom right corner, always as a pair.



PEOPLE FIRST

- 1 Real members, mid-project.** Hands dirty, work in progress, nothing staged.
- 2 Joy and pride on camera.** The smile after the last screw counts as much as the result.
- 3 Tools in hands.** Tools appear in use or being passed on, never as catalog shots.
- 4 Natural light, natural color.** Outdoors or bright workshops, colors as the eye sees them.
- 5 No heavy filters or presets.** Authenticity beats polish, every time.



TALK LIKE A NEIGHBOR

„Du“, never „Sie“. The community is on a first-name basis, so is the brand.

Short and concrete. Say what to do and why it helps. Skip the marketing gloss.

Encourage, don't sell. Every post invites people to make something, not to buy something.

German copy, shared hashtags. Captions speak the audience's language, hashtags connect beyond it.

„Manchmal braucht man einfach ein zweites Paar Hände.“

Sometimes you just need a second pair of hands.

[#DIYTogether](#) [#GemeinsamMehrSchaffen](#)

„Geliehenes Werkzeug kaputt? Kein Drama. So gehst du vor.“

Borrowed tool broke? No drama. Here's what to do.

[#TrustworthyTools](#)

„Drei Schritte, eine saubere Kante. Speicher dir das für Samstag.“

Three steps to a clean edge. Save it for Saturday.

[#QuickTip](#)

[#DIYTogether](#)

[#QuickTip](#)

[#DIYInspiration](#)

[#CreativeCrafts](#)

[#TrustworthyTools](#)

[#ToolSpotlight](#)

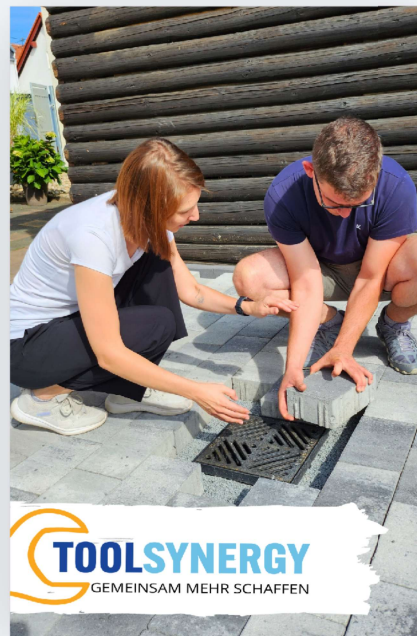
FIVE FORMATS, ONE RHYTHM

FORMAT	MESSAGE	CHANNELS	CADENCE	TAG
TOGETHER	Community in action: sharing tools, planning builds side by side	Instagram, Facebook	2× per week	#DIYTogether
QUICKTIP	20–40 second how-to videos, self-explanatory without a voiceover	YouTube Shorts, Reels	Every 2 weeks	#QuickTip
CREATIVE	Finished member projects, told step by step as carousels	Instagram, Pinterest	1× per week	#DIYInspiration
TRUST	FAQ pieces and member stories that answer real worries	Facebook, Instagram	1× per week	#TrustworthyTools
SPOTLIGHT	One tool per post: what it does and when you need it	Facebook, Pinterest	1× per week	#ToolSpotlight

THE SYSTEM ON THE FEED



Together · Feed post · 1080 × 1080



Spotlight · Pin · 2:3



QuickTip · Short · 9:16



Together · Link post · 1200 × 630



GEMEINSAM MEHR SCHAFFEN.

Achieve more together.

Toolsynergy is a fictional brand, created as part of a bachelor thesis on social media strategy and corporate design.

Concept, design and photography by [Valentin Lenzing](#).